

DAS CAPITAL CONTROL

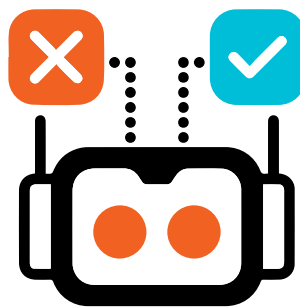
As **Shaktikanta Das**, the 25th Governor of the Reserve Bank of India, approaches the end of his second term in the later part of 2024, his tenure will be remembered for stabilising the institution amidst immense challenges. Following the sudden exit of **Urjit Patel**, Das calmed strained relations with the government. In recent years, he has calmed the waters again after the unprecedented challenges posed by the pandemic. Despite subsequent global challenges, such as the Russia-Ukraine war and the Israel-Hamas conflict, the Indian banking system has remained safe and stable.



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WHITHER THE E-₹?

The Reserve Bank of India has been working on various pilots for the Central Bank Digital Currency, seen as an official alternative to cryptocurrencies since it is backed and managed by the central bank. It's been a year since RBI launched separate pilots for wholesale and retail versions of the digital rupee or e-Rupee. It is looking now to expand the pilots. But when will they be rolled out on a larger scale and is 2024 that year? Official sources, however, caution that a full-scale introduction may take some more time.



INTELLIGENT DEBATE

THE DEVELOPMENT OF vastly improved AI tools over the past year has been unprecedented. But some of its use cases are being seen as harmful around the world. While it is also increasing productivity, policymakers around the world are working to curb its harmful effects through strict regulations. Balancing regulation with the need to spur innovation will be a challenge.

UNDER THE LENS

SME IPOs REACHED a record high in 2023, with 160 firms raising over ₹4,000 crore. The year had high subscriptions and listings, which raised eyebrows. Sebi and stock exchanges are closely monitoring the SME IPO segment, and in recent past, bourses have tightened SME listing norms. As Sebi wants to make the segment more attractive to real investors, these measures will be more visible in 2024.



POWER LADY

MADHABI PURI BUCH has been at the helm of Sebi for nearly two years. She has fully leveraged data and technology for regulatory duties, and 2024 will see her continue on that path. Her agenda: the Indian stock market will no longer follow the developed western markets but will lead in many areas, including transaction and settlement speed. Her term ends in February 2025. In 2024, she would have her last year to fully address the challenges she has highlighted. Watch this space.